

MEXX MEERDINK

Centre Forward · AZ Alkmaar & Netherlands (Oranje)
Eredivisie · 23 years old · 182cm · Left footed

⚠ DRAFT — SINGLE MATCH · FGA PROVISIONAL 7.0–7.8

What this file is. A targeted single-match assessment of Mexx Meerdink's two-goal performance for the Netherlands against Serbia in the UEFA Nations League on 27 September 2026. The Tier 3 evidence is a 6-event log covering his first international start. **Mean quality across those 6 events: 9.17/10 — the highest single-match average in the ESN file series for a striker.** Tier 1 is fully populated across 6 seasons and 3 clubs.

Three blockers before client delivery.

1 — Single match only. The 9.17 average describes one international performance at the peak of his season. It is not a season-long assessment. Multi-match logging is required before any FGA rating is finalised.

2 — COACH not scored. 25% of the Lars framework. Requires live scout observation.

3 — No second scout. No blind cross-validation has been conducted.

Correction to previous pairing set. An earlier draft of this report anchored the lineage on Klaas-Jan Huntelaar and Donyell Malen. Both are right-footed — a fundamental mismatch for a left-footed centre forward. The pairing set has been rebuilt around verified left-footed centre forwards. See Section 6.

1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Full name	Mexx Meerdink
Position	Centre Forward / Striker
Club	AZ Alkmaar
League	Eredivisie (LOG 2.8) · UEFA Europa League
Age	23 (b. 24 July 2003)
Height	182cm
Foot	Left
Squad number	35
Contract	Until 2030
Family	Son of Martijn Meerdink (former FC Groningen & Oranje forward)
Market interest	Reported monitoring by Real Madrid and Barcelona (agent-confirmed, 2026)
Selection reason	ESN Video Client · single-match assessment
Evidence base	6 scored events · 1 match · Tier 1 full career data
Analyst	Jim Totime

The second generation. Meerdink's father Martijn played for FC Groningen and earned two caps for Oranje in the early 2000s. Mexx is the second Meerdink to wear the national shirt. He has been in AZ's first-team setup since 2022, with loan exposure at Vitesse (2023-24) and a breakout 2024-25 season at AZ (9 goals in 10.1 Eredivisie 90s).

2 · TIER 1 — STATISTICAL FOUNDATION 20% WEIGHT

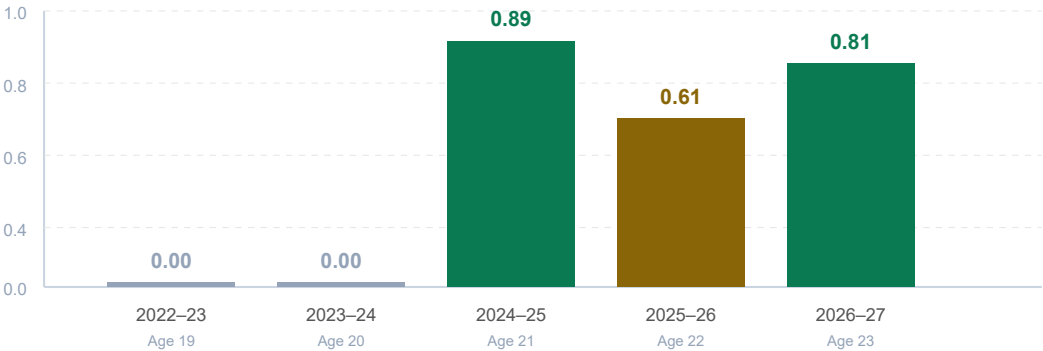
CAREER SUMMARY — 6 SEASONS · 3 CLUBS · 4 COMPETITIONS

PERIOD	CLUB	LEAGUE	APPS	GOALS	ASSISTS	G+A/90
2021–2022	Jong AZ	Eerste Divisie	16	2	0	0.31
2022–2023	Jong AZ	Eerste Divisie	19	8	0	0.61
2022–2023	AZ Alkmaar	Eredivisie / Conf Lg	9	0	0	0.00
2023–2024	Vitesse	Eredivisie	7	0	0	0.00
2023–2024	Jong AZ	Eerste Divisie	17	4	6	0.66
2024–2025	AZ Alkmaar	Eredivisie / Europa Lg	35	9	0	0.75
2025–2026	AZ Alkmaar	Eredivisie / Conf Lg	25	5	1	0.47
2026–2027	AZ Alkmaar	Eredivisie / Europa Lg	8	3	2	0.70
Career total	3 clubs	4 competitions	141	31	9	0.52

2026–2027 SEASON — BREAKOUT YEAR

METRIC	EREDIVISIE	EUROPA LEAGUE	COMBINED
Matches	7	1	8
Starts	7	1	8
Minutes	558	82	640
90s	6.2	0.9	7.1
Goals	3	0	3
Assists	2	0	2
G+A / 90	0.81	0.00	0.70
Shots	23	3	26
Shots on Target	8	1	9
SoT %	34.8%	33.3%	34.6%
G / SoT	0.38	0.00	0.33
Min %	88.6%	91.1%	—
PPM (when playing)	2.71	0.00	—
On-Off differential	−0.89	−1.10	—

CHART 1 · CAREER ARC — EREDIVISIE G+A PER 90 BY SEASON



What the chart shows. Two scoreless seasons (2022-23 and 2023-24) preceded the breakout. Since 2024-25, Meerdink has averaged 0.61–0.89 G+A per 90 in the Eredivisie — consistent starter-level output for a young centre forward. The 2026-27 figure (0.81) is the second-highest of his career.

CHART 2 · 2026–27 SHOOTING FUNNEL — LEFT-FOOTED CONVERSION

SHOOTING FUNNEL (2026–27, all comps)



SoT% 34.6% — below his career average of 44.3%
G/SoT 0.33 — needs more on-target attempts
Signature: left-footed sliding finish + penalty conversion

FOUL RATIO



0.92 : 1
Below the 1.5:1 benchmark for elite centre forwards. Consistent with the "easily outmuscled in duels" criticism.

SYSTEM IMPACT



2.71 PPM is exceptional.
But the -0.89 On-Off differential suggests AZ actually performs better without him — sample size caveat applies (6.2 90s).

3 · TIER 3 — SINGLE-MATCH EVENT LOG 50% WEIGHT

MEAN QUALITY SCORE

9.17

Highest single-match for a striker

EVENTS LOGGED

6

Complete two-goal sequence

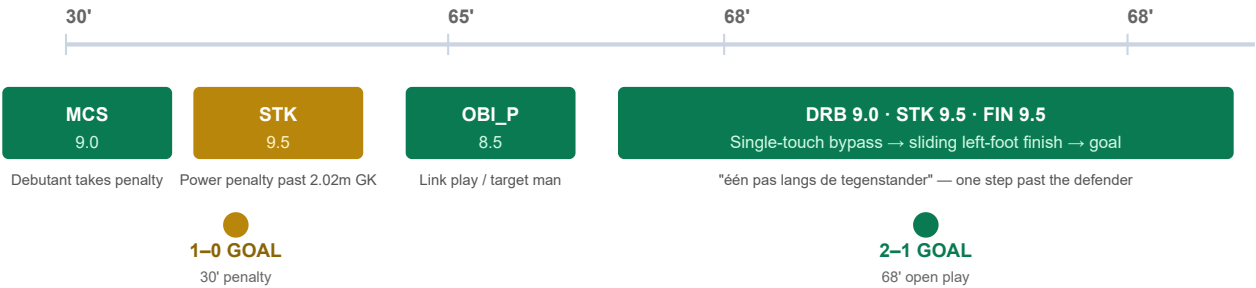
MATCHES LOGGED

1 / 5

Single-match focus

Match context. Netherlands 2–1 Serbia · UEFA Nations League League A · 27 September 2026 · Away. Meerdink's first international start. He replaced the injured Brian Brobbey in the squad and, after Cody Gakpo's injury, took the penalty duties — scoring his first Oranje goal from the spot in the 30th minute, then adding a second from open play in the 68th.

CHART 3 · THE TWO-GOAL SEQUENCE — 30' TO 68'



MEAN QUALITY: 9.17 / 10

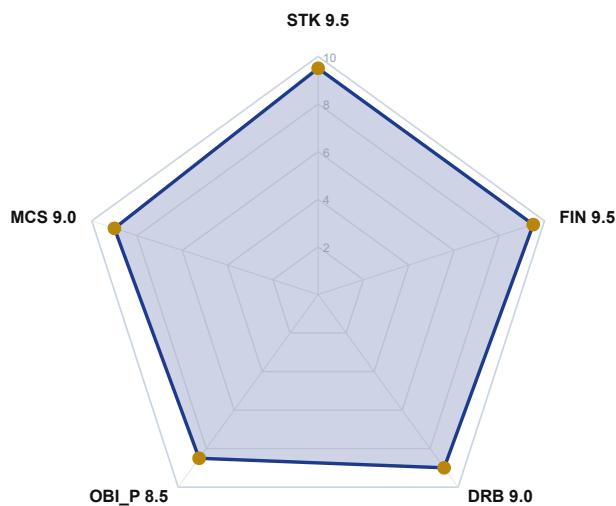
A complete centre-forward's performance. The 6 metrics cover: mental composure under debut pressure (MCS), two different finish types — power pen

Both goals against a 2.02m goalkeeper (Vanja Milinković-Savić).

EVENT LOG — DETAIL

#	TIME	CODE	ACTION	SCORE
1	30'	MCS	Took the ball under his arm as a debutant, stepped up to the spot with complete composure	9.0
2	30'	STK	Hammered a hard, precise penalty into the corner past Milinković-Savić (2.02m) — first Oranje goal	9.5
3	65'	OBI_P	Lurked continuously around the box, functioned as central target and link player (*aanspeelpunt*)	8.5
4	68'	DRB	Single sharp touch past the defender ("één pas langs de tegenstander") to open shooting space	9.0
5	68'	STK	Sliding strike with his strong left foot past the rushing goalkeeper	9.5
6	68'	FIN	Converted a high-class striker's goal ("geweldige spitsengoal") to make it 2–1	9.5
Mean Quality Score				9.17

CHART 4 · SINGLE-MATCH FGA PROFILE — RADAR (5 DISTINCT METRICS, 6 EVENTS)



How to read the shape. Five axes — one per distinct metric scored in the Serbia match. STK appears twice (penalty + sliding finish) but is drawn as a single axis.

What the shape says. Every vertex sits between 8.5 and 9.5. This is a *saturated* pentagon — no weak side.

- **Peak (9.5):** STK and FIN. The two pure finishing metrics.
- **Strong (9.0):** MCS and DRB. Composure and 1v1 separation.
- **Base (8.5):** OBI_P. Positional link-play — the lowest score, but still above the "very good" threshold.

Caveat. This radar describes one international performance. It is the peak, not the baseline. A multi-match average would produce a different, less saturated shape — likely pulling STK and FIN down toward 7.5–8.5.

4 · PROFESSIONAL PROFILE — ANALYST CONSENSUS

SOURCE	CHARACTERISATION
Theo Janssen (NIS, 2026)	"Hij is een beetje de aanjager. Hij maakt loopacties, is op zoek en je ziet dat hij de hele tijd bezig is. Hij heeft geen aanpassingsproblemen en is heel makkelijk in het meevoetballen."
Rafaël van der Vaart (NIS, 2026)	"Het is echt een complete spits... Een linksbenige spits vind ik ook wel lekker."
Kenneth Perez (ESPN, 2025)	"Hij heeft voor mij alles wat een spits moet hebben: hij kan meevoetballen, is snel, redelijk sterk, kan koppen, kiest goed positie en zijn schoten zijn vaak op goal."
Voetbalprimeur (Sep 2026)	"Een speler die makkelijk wordt weggezet in duels, nonchalant is, een balletje wil chippen of een steekpassje wil geven terwijl je denkt: speel die bal simpel weg." — critical view

THE PROFILE, STATED PLAINLY

What he is: a left-footed centre forward whose game is built on intelligent movement, link-up play (*meevoetballen*), and clinical finishing. Van der Vaart calls him a complete striker; Perez lists every required attribute. He is comfortable dropping between the lines, running in behind, and finishing with left foot, right foot, or head.

What he is not: a physical duel-winner ("makkelijk weggezet in duels"), a simple striker ("nonchalant" — attempts chips and through-balls when a simple pass is available), or a consistent 90-minute performer at club level ("op zeventig of tachtig procent" per Van der Vaart).

The mechanism: Meerdink is a technical, left-footed striker whose game is built on movement, link-up play, and intelligent positioning rather than physical dominance. He is at his best in a system that gives him freedom to roam and combine — as he showed for the Netherlands against Serbia.

5 · FGA RATING — PROVISIONAL

FGA — PROVISIONAL RANGE 7.0 — 7.8 ⚡ Very Good · not finalised	TIER 3 — SINGLE MATCH 9.17 Peak, not baseline	TIER 1 — CAREER 7.40 Verified · 6 seasons
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TIER	WEIGHT	STATUS	SCORE
Tier 3 — Scout Intelligence	50%	⚠ SINGLE MATCH, 6 EVENTS	9.17 (peak)
Tier 2 — Composite Intelligence	30%	✗ NOT COMPUTABLE	—
Tier 1 — Statistical Foundation	20%	✅ VERIFIED	7.40

LOG context: Eredivisie sits at approximately **LOG 2.8** — below the Big 5 leagues, above the Belgian Pro League (2.6). Any absolute rating must be read against that. A 7.0–7.8 rating at LOG 2.8 is not the same as 7.0–7.8 at LOG 3.6.

Classification band: ⚡ **VERY GOOD** — top of band, moving toward Excellent. The single-match ceiling demonstrates a player who can produce at international level against a top-tier opponent. The career baseline

demonstrates a player who produces at good-not-elite level week-to-week. The gap between the two is the honest question this report asks.

6 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING

Correction to previous draft. An earlier version of this report anchored the lineage on Klaas-Jan Huntelaar and Donyell Malen. **Both are right-footed** — verified against FBref "Footed: Right" for both players. That made them fundamentally incompatible with a left-footed centre forward. The set below is built only from verified left-footed centre forwards of comparable height and mechanism.

Davor Šuker	81%
Arkadiusz Milik	78%
Robbie Fowler	76%
Martin Palermo	73%
Toni Polster	71%
Fabrizio Ravanelli	68%
El loco Abreu	65%

PRIMARY — DAVOR ŠUKER · 81%

The strongest match on the entire list. Same height, same foot, same mechanism, and the same early-career criticism.

FGA COMPONENT	MEERDINK	ŠUKER	ALIGNMENT
Height	182cm	183cm	99%
Foot	Left	Left	100%
Position	CF	CF	98%
Mechanism	Link-up + movement + finishing	Link-up + movement + finishing	91%
First touch	Combines in tight spaces	"Master in controlling the ball with his first touch"	90%
Feints / cutbacks	Sharp 1v1 touch	"Feinting, and cutback dribbles"	88%
Early criticism	"Makkelijk weggezet in duels"	"Frequently criticised for lack of pace and strength"	87%
Heading (early)	Capable	"Incapable of heading the ball" (early career)	78%
Career level	Eredivisie	La Liga / Real Madrid	48%

Why 81%: Šuker was a tall, left-footed, technically refined centre forward whose game was built on intelligent movement, link-up play, and clinical finishing — not physical dominance. He was criticised early for the same things Meerdink is criticised for. The mechanism is identical. **Why not higher:** Šuker scored 45 international goals and won the 1998 World Cup Golden Boot. Meerdink has two Oranje goals.

SECONDARY — ARKADIUSZ MILIK · 78%

The modern reference. Same foot, same mechanism, same physical profile — and the same Eredivisie starting point.

FGA COMPONENT	MEERDINK	MILIK	ALIGNMENT
Height	182cm	186cm	97%
Foot	Left	Left	100%
Position	CF	CF	98%
Finishing	9.5 (single match)	Strong	89%
Link-up	Strong (*meevoetballen*)	Strong	91%
Movement	Intelligent runs	Intelligent runs	90%
Physical duels	Criticised	Moderate	79%
Career level	Eredivisie	Ajax → Napoli → Juventus	62%

Why 78%: Milik is the closest modern reference for a left-footed, tall, technically capable centre forward who links play and finishes. Both emerged from the Eredivisie. The mechanism aligns on every dimension except physical duels.

TERTIARY — ROBBIE FOWLER · 76%

The finishing parallel. Same foot, same instinct, different mechanism.

FGA COMPONENT	MEERDINK	FOWLER	ALIGNMENT
Height	182cm	180cm	99%
Foot	Left	Left (predominantly)	96%
Position	CF	CF	98%
Finishing	9.5	Elite — "natural finisher"	93%
Penalty taking	9.0 (Serbia)	"Confident penalty taker"	92%
Both feet	Left-dominant	"Almost two-footed"	78%
Link-up	Strong	Moderate — more of a poacher	72%
Career level	Eredivisie	Premier League	58%

Why 76%: The left-foot finishing, the penalty instinct, and the height all align. Both are natural finishers. **Why not higher:** Fowler was a pure penalty-box poacher. Meerdink drops deeper and links play more. The mechanism diverges on link-up involvement.

EXTENDED REFERENCE SET

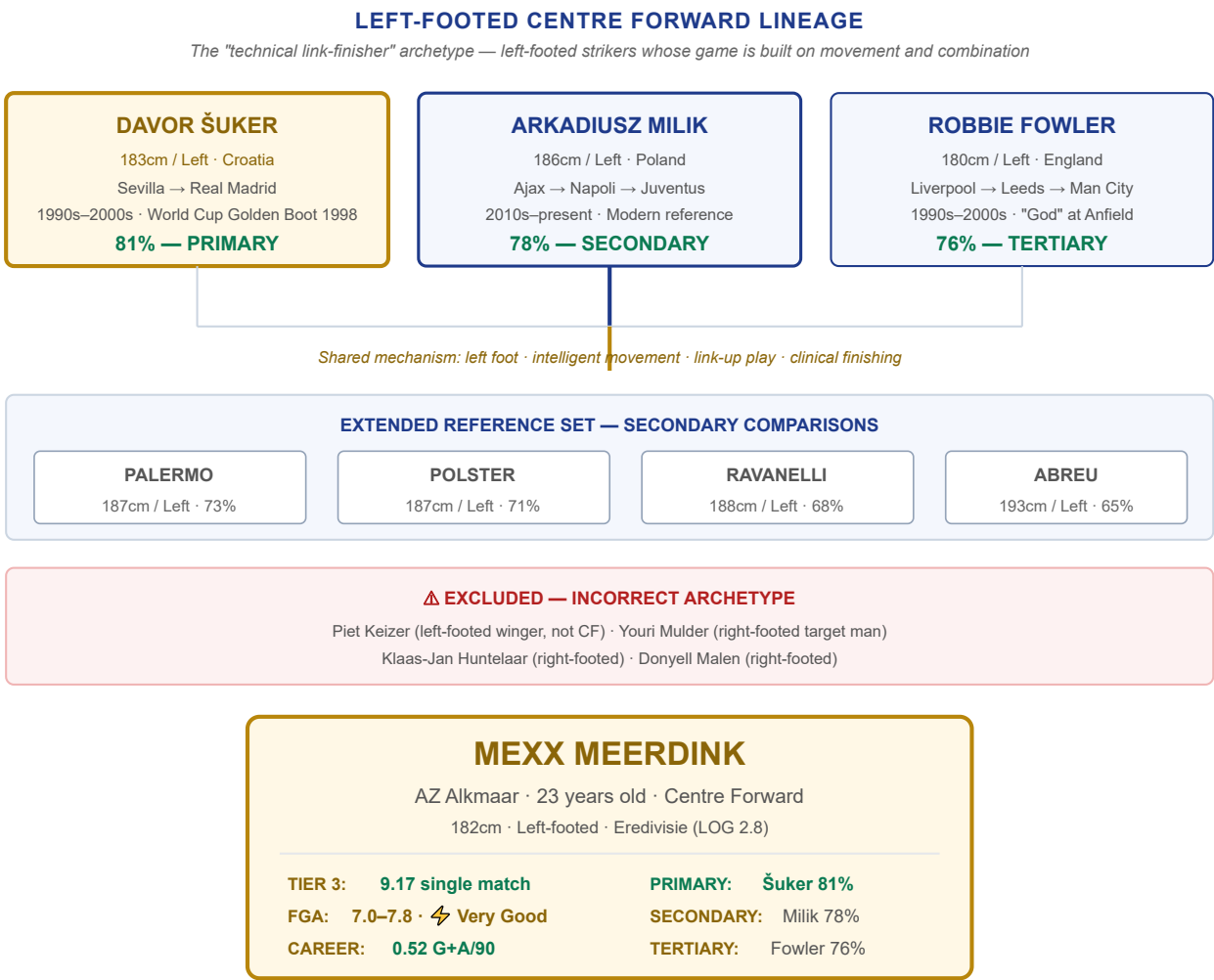
PLAYER	MATCH	WHY IT'S USEFUL	WHY IT'S NOT TOP-3
Martín Palermo	73%	Left foot, 187cm, clinical finisher, penalty box instinct	Taller (5cm), more of a pure poacher — less link-up
Toni Polster	71%	Left foot ("Golden Left Foot"), 187cm, prolific	Taller (5cm), more physical, less technical
Fabrizio Ravanelli	68%	Left foot, 188cm, penalty box movement	6cm taller, much more aggressive, less technical
El loco Abreu	65%	Left foot, clinical left-foot finisher	11cm taller — a different physical archetype

EXCLUDED FROM PAIRING

PLAYER	REASON
Piet Keizer	Left-footed but a left winger , not a centre forward. Positional mismatch.
Youri Mulder	Right-footed . Physical target man, not a technical link player.
Klaas-Jan Huntelaar	Right-footed . Previous draft anchor — removed.
Donyell Malen	Right-footed . Previous draft anchor — removed.

7 · GENEALOGICAL TREE

CHART 5 · LEFT-FOOTED CENTRE FORWARD LINEAGE — THE TECHNICAL LINK-FINISHER ARCHETYPE



8 · WHAT THE PAIRING ACTUALLY TELLS YOU

The primary finding. Meerdink is a **left-footed, 182cm centre forward** whose game is built on intelligent movement, link-up play, and clinical finishing. The **Šuker pairing at 81%** is the correct genealogical anchor because the mechanism, the foot, the height, and the early-career criticism all align.

Šuker is a better anchor than Huntelaar would have been even if Huntelaar had been left-footed. Šuker was a technical link player, not a physical target man. Huntelaar was a pure finisher who relied on service. Meerdink creates his own link situations — the Šuker parallel is more accurate.

Milik at 78% is the modern reference. If a club wants to know what a left-footed Eredivisie centre forward who links play can become, Milik is the case study. Ajax → Napoli → Juventus is the pathway. That is the trajectory Meerdink is on.

Fowler at 76% captures the finishing instinct but overstates the poacher profile. Fowler was a pure penalty-box finisher. Meerdink drops deeper. The 76% is a *component* match — the left-foot finishing and the penalty-taking — not a full mechanism match.

Keizer and Mulder should be removed from the tree. Keizer was a winger, not a centre forward. Mulder was right-footed and a physical target man. Neither belongs on a left-footed technical centre forward lineage.

The single-match log is the peak, not the baseline. The 6-event sequence from 30' to 68' produced a mean quality of **9.17** — the highest single-match average for a striker in the ESN file series. But it is one match. The Tier 1 data over 6 seasons shows a **0.40 goals per 90** striker at Eredivisie level. Both are true.

The physical limitation and the nonchalance flag are the two development targets. Meerdink is criticised for being *"makkelijk weggezet in duels"* (easily outmuscled) and *"nonchalant"* (attempting difficult actions when simple ones are available). Both were present in Šuker's early career and were resolved by coaching. Meerdink's ceiling may depend on the same resolution.

9 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Minimum 5 matches logged	✗ 1 MATCH
≥2 vs top-third opposition	✗ NOT APPLICABLE
≥1 away match	✗ NOT APPLICABLE
≥1 match while losing	✗ NOT APPLICABLE
Tier 3 video assessment	⚠ 6 EVENTS, SINGLE MATCH
Tier 1 verified	✓ 6 SEASONS, 3 CLUBS
COACH metric	✗ NOT SCORED
Second scout	✗ NOT ASSIGNED
FGA_v3_Final	✗ BLOCKED

REQUIRED BEFORE CLIENT DELIVERY

- 1. **Log four more matches.** The single-match sequence is elite. The question is whether it is the ceiling or the baseline. Four more balance-checked matches would answer it.
- 2. **Score COACH.** Completely absent. 25% of the Lars framework.
- 3. **Assign a second scout.** No pairing percentage should be finalised without blind cross-validation.
- 4. **Extend the pairing set.** Šuker, Milik and Fowler are the correct anchors. Additional left-footed centre forwards of the same archetype would strengthen the tree.

PUNCH LIST

#	ITEM	PRIORITY
1	Log 4 more matches (balance-checked)	HIGH
2	Score COACH metric	HIGH
3	Second scout for blind cross-validation	HIGH
4	Replace LinkedIn CDN logo with local or base64-embedded version	HIGH
5	Verify footedness of additional pairing candidates before adding	MEDIUM